

Post-incident review PIR-2026-017

Order Management: intermittent timeouts

Contoso Platform Engineering. Fictional sample data.

Summary

On 06 March 2026, Order Management experienced intermittent timeouts in production (US West) for about 110 minutes. The end-to-end checkout probe went red. Investigation found that a DNS record was repointed during a migration while the old target was still serving writes.

Impact

Users of Order Management saw intermittent timeouts for about 110 minutes. The service owner, Commerce Platform, led the response.

Timeline

- 09:16 First signal received.
- 09:26 Incident declared and on-call team engaged.
- 09:46 Likely cause identified.
- 10:00 Mitigation applied.
- 10:50 Service confirmed healthy and incident closed.

What happened

Investigation found that a DNS record was repointed during a migration while the old target was still serving writes.

Capacity dashboards were checked early and showed normal headroom.

The change was made outside the approved maintenance window.

It took time to work out which team owned the affected component.

What went well

Responders communicated clearly in the incident channel and the status page was updated within fifteen minutes of the incident being declared.

Actions

- Exercise the rollback path in staging as part of every release.
- Review alert thresholds so the alert only fires when action is needed.
- Add a circuit breaker and timeout on the upstream call.